

Breathing system

Also called the respiratory system, the breathing system is made up of two lungs and the tubes, or airways, that carry air into and out of the body. Inside the lungs, those airways divide over and over again to form smaller and smaller branches.

The **nasal cavity** is a space behind the nose where the air we breathe is cleaned. Mucus traps dirt and germs and tiny hairlike cilia sweep the mucus to the throat.



Branching airways

Air travels through the nasal cavity and along the windpipe, or trachea. At its base, the trachea splits into two smaller tubes, called bronchi (each one is called a bronchus), which go into the lungs. These go into narrower and narrower bronchi and bronchioles.

The **right lung** is larger than the left, which has to make room for the heart

Alveoli are tiny air bags found at the ends of the bronchioles. Oxygen passes into the bloodstream through the walls of the alveoli.

